

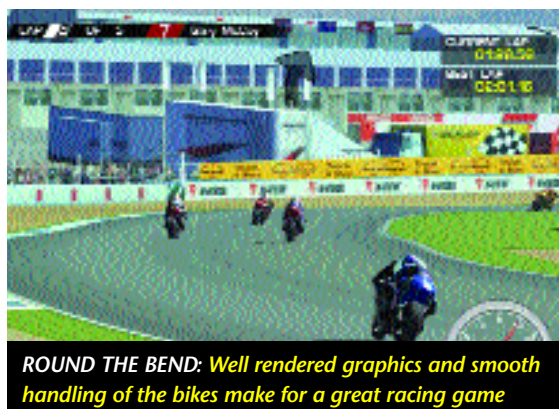
MOTOGP: ULTIMATE RACING TECHNOLOGY

Of Burning Rubber and Hairpin Curves

Developed originally for the Xbox, PS2, and the Game Boy Advance, the PC version of *MotoGP: Ultimate Racing Technology* is made for the thrill seeking. Racers such as Kenny Roberts and Valentino Rossi battle it out with some of the world's fastest machines such as Suzuki, Yamaha and Honda.

While beginners will find it fairly easy to get the hang of their bikes, honing your skills in the finer aspects of racing will take some practice. That's where the various game modes such as Quick Race, Time Trials, Training, Arcade Championship and Grand Prix series come into play.

You can either play as one of the many professional racers or create your own rider identity. You are given 10 points, which are distributed among four skill categories: Cornering, Braking, Top speed and Acceleration. Each skill category has 10 training missions and each mission gives you one skill point. The missions gradually increase in difficulty



and each requires a different skill set. While Quick Race and Time Trials stress on setting the best lap times, Arcade Championship gives you points based on your performance in the race. The Grand Prix series mode lets you take part in the practice and qualifying rounds on each track before racing and your point total at the end of the series determines your standing in the tournament.

Visually, this game is simply delightful. Details such as the shadows on certain parts of the tracks that are lined with trees while racing with the 'Sunny' setting turned on, and the sound of thunder and the flash of lightning while racing on a rainy day, add to the replay value of the game.

What you will miss is the actual realism involved in Grand Prix racing—running off the track as you try to manoeuvre a sharp curve only decreases the bike's speed. The game also places you astride automatically when you take a spill, taking away from the realism of the crash. But even though this does make things a wee bit easy, getting through the tracks and making good time won't be so simple. All in all, this is one high octane racing game that should put the fire beneath you!

Minimum System Requirements: Pentium II 400 MHz, 64 MB RAM, 300 MB hard disk space, 3D accelerator card, CD-ROM drive, DirectX 8.x
Genre: Sport ■ **Developer:** Climax ■ **Distributor:** Milestone Interactive ■ **Phone:** 022-8381614 ■ **Web site:** <http://motogp.thq.de> ■ **Price:** Rs 799
■ **Rating:** ★★★★★☆

DIE HARD: NAKATOMI PLAZA

Not Worth Dying For

Die Hard: Nakatomi Plaza is another FPS based on a popular franchise, this time on a popular 1980s action film.

The game emulates the plot of the movie and puts you in the place of John McClane, a smart-talking New York cop who fights German terrorists to save his wife. The game features several original levels throughout the Plaza building. Instead of a small group of terrorists, like in the movie, you'll find one at every nook and cranny. Since the entire game is set at the Nakatomi Plaza building, the environments are repetitive, with offices, offices and some more offices. This makes the environment claustrophobic and the gameplay uninteresting.



It does feature some well-scripted missions where you have to defuse bombs, cut wires and save civilians. The game's winning points are its realistic environments and impressive in-game cinematics. The offices look plush, with good

attention to detail, but there's not much to break the monotony. The Lithtech engine (which was used for *No One Lives Forever*) has been used here, but not to the best effect. The weapon range is limited—there's only a standard machine gun, an M16, a 9 mm pistol, a heavy machine gun and a sniper rifle. The AI is interesting, with the SWAT teams and the terrorists hiding and dodging you, but there's nothing out of the ordinary.

The game is a good first effort from Piranha Games—well rendered and executed. The cinematics and cut scenes give the intended Hollywood feel, but *Die Hard: Nakatomi Plaza* offers very little that a dozen other FPS' don't.

Minimum System Requirements: 400 MHz processor, 64 MB RAM, 16 MB Direct3D graphics card **Genre:** First Person Shooter
■ **Developer:** Piranha Games ■ **Distributor:** World Wide CD ROMs **Phone:** 022-5006661 ■ **Web site:** www.sierra.com/games/diehard/
■ **Price:** Rs 999 ■ **Rating:** ★★★★★☆